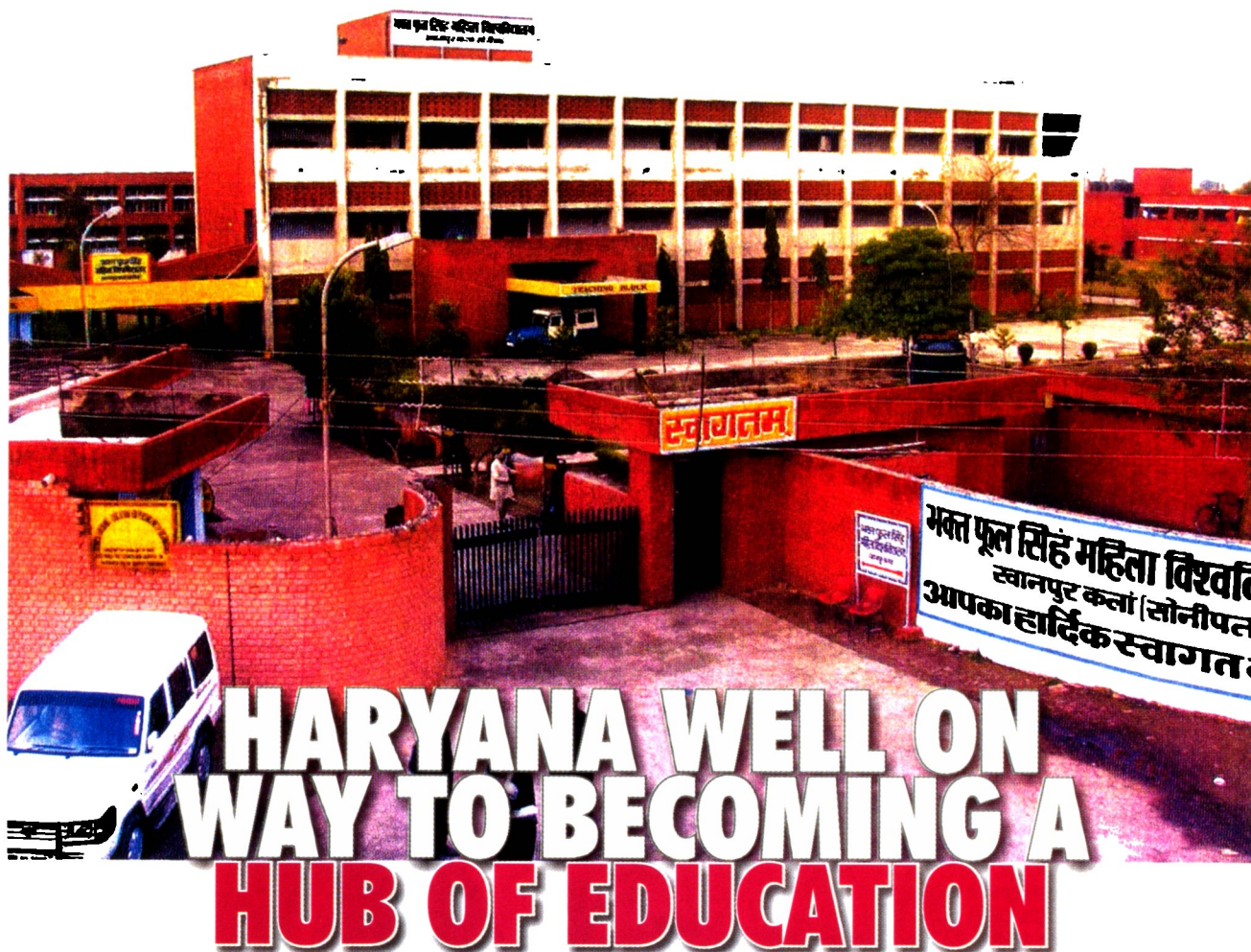




Reforms making way for private sector, new universities and central institutes point to the direction

Vision, they say, is a rare virtue among politicians who are generally known for not looking beyond the nose which, in political parlance, means five years. But it is vision that tells a statesman from the ranks of politicians, makes him stand tall, and emerge as a true leader whose futuristic thoughts and actions script the future of the state.

It is an open secret that soon after assuming the office of Chief Minister, Mr Bhupinder Singh Hooda had shared with other leaders his vision of making Haryana number one state in the country and, in the field of education, a modern Takshila, a real hub of excellence in higher education. The politician in him knew full well that work in the field of education may not fetch votes but the statesman in him impelled him to move forward and lay the foundation of a good

future for the state and its youth.

The reality sunk in him that educational avenues would offer the industry in the state a ready and perennial source of skilled manpower, help revv up the engines of growth, and make the state a cynosure of all investing eyes. Realising full well that investment in education is investment in future and can help catapult Haryana to number one position, Hooda set out to see his vision of making Haryana a modern Takshila, a reality.

TWELVE VARSITIES NOW: FIVE IN FIRST 40 YEARS

And the efforts put in by the team led by the Chief Minister have brought the ground level reality closer to his vision. Nothing explains this better than the fact that Haryana which saw only five universities---KU, GJU, MDU, HAU and Chaudhary Devi Lal University---come up in the first

forty years of its existence, has witnessed almost double the number either come up or being signed for, during the last four years of the Hooda Government.

Besides, the Congress Government has succeeded in bringing a large number of central institutes to the state, opened a large number of colleges and upgraded some to the level of varsities. No gainsaying the fact that besides the good track record of the Hooda Government, the strategic location of Haryana, being on the periphery of the national capital of Delhi, did help Haryana bag some central institutes.

The varsities coming up in the state include Defence University at Gurgaon; Central University along with a medical college at Mahendargarh; IIM at Rohtak; Animal Husbandry University at Hisar; Medical Science and

Research University and All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIMS) at Rohtak besides five private universities for which legislation has been enacted by the Haryana Assembly.

FIRST UNIVERSITY FOR WOMEN SET UP

Then there are a host of centres of excellence set up to bring global standard education to Haryana. Scoring a first in North India, Haryana has set up Bhagat Phool Singh University for Women in Sonapat District whose sprawling complex has changed the skyline within a record time of one year. The Rajiv Gandhi Education City at Kundli in Sonapat District has begun to attract global standard schools of excellence. The Footwear and Design Institute at Bahadurgarh in Rohtak plans to turn out manpower not only for leading shoe makers in India but also in Asia.